

BUILDING MASTERY

MASTERY IS DOING THINGS THAT MAKE YOU FEEL COMPETENT, SELF-CONFIDENT, IN CONTROL, AND CAPABLE OF MASTERING THINGS.

Why Build Mastery?

Building a sense of confidence and competence makes a person more resistant to depression and other negative emotions.

Building mastery usually requires doing something that is at least a little bit hard or challenging. The idea is to generate a sense of accomplishment. Over time, a series of accomplishments leads to more positive self-concept, higher self-esteem, and an overall greater level of happiness.

How to Build Mastery?

1. Plan on doing at least one thing each day to build a sense of accomplishment.
2. Plan for success, not failure
 - Do something difficult, but possible
3. Gradually increase the difficulty over time.
 - If the first task is too difficult, do something a little easier the next time.
4. Look for a challenge.
 - If the task is too easy, try something a little harder the next time.

Make a list of things that you can do in order to gain a sense of mastery.

Make sure that the tasks are realistic goals for each mood state.

Remember that it is harder to do everything when you are depressed, so pick small tasks for when you are in a low mood.

Mastery tasks when in a Good Mood:

- 1.
- 2.

Mastery tasks when in a Low Mood:

- 1.
- 2.